■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Monday, October 05, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *Trump Claims Canada Has Been Imposing Secret Tariffs on the US: 'Nobody Knew' Except Me*

The Angle: *Trump is reviving US-Canada trade tension with a wild claim that Canada's been quietly slapping tariffs on American goods all along — and that he was the only one who caught it. It's classic Trump bravado dropped right into an already touchy trade relationship, which makes it prime debate fuel.*

- **Trump** claims **Canada** has been imposing secret tariffs on the US
- He says **'nobody knew'** about it — except him
- Comes amid ongoing US-Canada trade friction that's been simmering for months

The Debate Starter

- Do you buy that Trump 'alone' uncovered a secret Canadian tariff — or is this just more trade-war theater?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.yahoo.com/news/politics/articles/trump-claims-canada-imposing-secret-201116335.html

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■ *"Letters announcing medical-debt relief arrive as a welcome surprise." Kentucky Governor Andy Beshear wiping out medical debt for 140,000 Kentuckians*

The Angle: *Imagine opening your mailbox and finding out your medical debt just vanished - that's happening right now across Kentucky, and it's the kind of good-news story that makes people ask 'wait, is my state doing this too?'*

- Kentucky Governor **Andy Beshear** is wiping out medical debt for **140,000 Kentuckians**
- The relief is arriving the old-fashioned way - **letters landing in mailboxes** statewide
- Recipients describe it as a total surprise - no application, no warning, just debt gone

The Feel-Good Phone-In

- Would you want your governor doing this, and should every state be looking at Kentucky's playbook right now?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.wbur.org/hereandnow/2026/10/02/medical-debt-relief

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■ *Avengers: Endgame once again beats Avatar as highest-grossing movie of all time*

The Angle: *Avengers: Endgame once again beats Avatar as highest-grossing movie of all time*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/avengers-endgame-avatar-box-office-record-9.7369846?cmp=rss

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■■ *Mamdani charges ahead with another careless promise: Unfunded NYC 2-K*

The Angle: *NYC's democratic socialist mayor is expanding his signature childcare push to 2-year-olds, and it's the latest flashpoint in the national fight over how far "free government stuff" can go before the bills come due.*

- **Mayor Mamdani** is expanding his push for "free" childcare in New York City
- The new target: a **"2-K"** program extending free care down to **2-year-olds**

- Critics (via the **NY Post**) say the price tag for his childcare ambitions **keeps growing** with no funding plan attached

The Debate Starter

- Is universal childcare worth the price tag, or is this socialism writing checks the city can't cash?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/05/opinion/mamdani-charges-ahead-with-another-careless-promise-unfunded-nyc-2-k/

■■ *Husband of Chinese spy who allegedly stalked Taiwan president's son for communist regime dodges questions at court*

The Angle: *This is a real espionage case playing out in a US courtroom - the husband of an accused Chinese spy allegedly helped stalk the Taiwan president's own son on American soil, which pulls China-Taiwan-US tensions right into a Los Angeles courthouse.*

- The defendant, identified as **Zhang**, is accused of helping his wife - an alleged **Chinese spy** - stalk the son of **Taiwan's president**.
- Prosecutors say the alleged surveillance was carried out on behalf of the **Communist regime** in Beijing.
- **Zhang** dodged questions when he faced the judge in a **downtown Los Angeles** courtroom.
- He showed up to the hearing in a **high-collared designer jacket**, black pants, highlighted hair - and **shackles**.

The Debate Starter

- A foreign government allegedly stalking a world leader's kid on US soil - does that freak you out more than it probably should?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/05/us-news/alleged-chinese-spy-in-taiwan-leader-plot-appears-in-la-court/

Backup options:

■ *EXCLUSIVE: Senior Toronto cop charged with impaired driving, sources say he was found asleep at wheel*

The Angle: *A senior Toronto police officer getting popped for impaired driving is one thing - but sources say he was found passed out behind the wheel. The irony of a cop who's supposed to enforce the law getting caught like this is pure watercooler gold.*

- A **senior Toronto police officer** has been **charged with impaired driving**
- Sources say he was **found asleep at the wheel**
- Story broke as a **CTV News exclusive**

The Debate Starter

- Should the badge make the punishment worse, not better, when a cop breaks the exact law they enforce?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMi2wFBVV95cUxPV25fM1pfWUZVeHB2ejZkbkdzS2N5ZGRvWHE1V2Zsa1pqQVFtel9fM0hEZkNqSTRtem90Q1FDQ3ZWTXNDRThGVW4zRENia2RVNm5zRFl6Z090bEt0VVltQWR4Q2pJejA1SjJta1BlY1pkUlpDb0Rzc0pYWGRYZEt0aUV4bEZpcm9sb25vUlRINzBpTV81OTRydnEwQzl1ck9uTUlkVkMwQ2NBLUpEbHhCeWdTM0FrRHQxa001OUdoNGFrWXM0TU51Z3Vpb3RRMHVTS1A3QVFfOHc1cFE?oc=5

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *Is It Treason to Ask America to Help Break Up Canada?*

The Angle: *A provocative post floating American intervention to split up Canada is stirring real anger on r/canada - it taps into raw nerve about sovereignty, nationalism, and cross-border tension that's been simmering since the tariff/annexation talk started.*

The Debate Starter

- Is even asking the question an act of betrayal - or just free speech blowing off steam?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://thewalrus.ca/is-it-treason-to-ask-america-to-help-break-up-canada/

■■ *Toronto-based VPN provider plans to quit Canada over lawful-access bill*

The Angle: *A Toronto VPN company says it would rather shut down shop than comply with a new lawful-access bill — a real privacy-vs-surveillance fight that touches anyone who's ever used a VPN to watch Netflix or protect their data.*

- A **Toronto-based VPN provider** says it's prepared to **exit Canada** entirely
- The move is a direct response to a proposed **lawful-access bill**
- The company argues compliance would undermine the privacy protections VPNs are built to provide

The Debate Starter

- Would you be okay giving police easier access to online data if it meant losing your VPN provider?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theglobeandmail.com/politics/article-psiphon-vpn-provider-plans-to-quit-canada-over-lawful-access-bill/

■ *U.S. Coast Guard identifies all 6 passengers, crew of missing Canadian air ambulance*

The Angle: *This one's hitting home for Canadians - a medical flight out of Ontario vanished off Massachusetts, and now we finally have names and faces to put to the story everyone's been watching.*

- **U.S. Coast Guard** has identified all **six people** aboard the missing aircraft.
- **Four of the six** are Canadian.
- The plane was an **Ontario-based air ambulance**.
- It went missing off the coast of **Massachusetts** on **Saturday**.

The Heart-of-It Moment

- This isn't just a plane story anymore - it's six real families waiting on an answer right now.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/missing-canadian-air-ambulance-identities-9.7370505?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *Fact check: Is this Alberta separatist real or AI-generated?*

The Angle: *An AI-generated video of a fake University of Alberta student is circulating to push the separatist cause ahead of Alberta's Oct. 19 referendum — a real test of how deepfakes could sway an actual vote.*

- **CBC** fact-checked a viral video and found the "**University of Alberta student**" featured in it **doesn't exist** — he's **AI-generated**.
- The fake video is being used to **promote Alberta separatism** online.
- Alberta's **provincial referendum** on separation is set for **Oct. 19**.
- This flags a growing worry: **AI-faked people** shaping real political debates before a vote.

The Debate Starter

- If a fake AI 'student' can help push a real vote on splitting up a province, how do you trust anything online before an election?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/player/play/9.7370341?cmp=rss

■ *Weston Dressler inducted into UND Hall of Fame*

The Angle: *Weston Dressler became a Roughriders cult hero and one of the CFL's most electric returners - now the University of North Dakota is enshrining him in its Hall of Fame, a nice full-circle moment for Canadian*

football fans who watched him blow up on this side of the border.

The Tribute Beat

- Call in with your favorite Weston Dressler moment in Roughriders green.

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMimgFBVV95cUxQY0lFN3RaLXFZOFRjbm1DaldMMGI1WnJrdlRWMHlzN29sNUJpMVJQd0ZJLVBCaElpRk1VaXBYTDBWeFdrQk96NGZtd05hYmZEaW5YMF9rbDVMcTRIQ2dHcG9RVEFlSkg0RExSWFE1bVFIUnlRUW44R19qbVotZ3VYeGU4QTVWbUJBb2JVWmt3Z3d2aWdjTGtybVdR?oc=5

■ *Gas prices expected to continue rising despite G7 releasing millions of barrels of oil and fuel*

The Angle: *This is the kind of disconnect that makes people furious at the pump - world powers release emergency oil supply specifically to bring prices down, and it's not working. Everybody driving to work feels this one directly.*

- **G7 nations** are releasing **millions of barrels** of oil and fuel reserves to try to ease pump prices.
- Despite that massive supply push, gas prices are still expected to keep rising, not fall.

The Wallet Check

- Call in: what are you paying at the pump this week, and is it actually changing what you drive or where you go?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMi0gFBVV95cUxPM3NkQTRrc3NDTHc0akdUTU9UZmo2eE9tSjhlUEFTUnAyanFqZkN2blVXRUlhajlLLXpDZG83b08xdUJtWmJiWWg3SnQtY1haUDJjR0xyakZCWGdNb2FSc0lYVEE5WWNfLXF3eUhsZ0lmN1JoeC0xRzd0cWh1T3JDWGp1NXFYNmxVSXJuY0hXLV9CQURfWXl0V29RaWE3aVlpbmVqTE1SWThHc0xRU0VfUW1HMFBtejYySGpvc09UMklQSHZaMmVzNzRrOHZWblJ2X2c?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Saturday Night Live: Dakota Johnson struggles through weak episode as Taylor Swift gatecrashes*

The Angle: *Dakota Johnson's hosting stint is getting panned as one of the weaker episodes of the season, but a surprise Taylor Swift cameo is the only thing anyone's actually talking about this morning.*

- **Dakota Johnson** hosted **Saturday Night Live** this week
- Critics and viewers are calling the episode one of the **weaker** installments of the season
- **Taylor Swift** reportedly made a surprise, unannounced appearance during the show
- The Swift cameo is getting more buzz online than the sketches themselves

The Debate Starter

- Can one surprise A-list cameo save an SNL episode that's otherwise bombing?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theguardian.com/tv-and-radio/2026/oct/04/saturday-night-live-dakota-johnson-host-taylor-swift-cameo

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■ *'Carrie' Rotten Tomatoes Reviews: New Adaptation Of Stephen King Novel Is Bloody Good*

The Angle: *Stephen King remakes usually get roasted, so critics calling this new 'Carrie' adaptation 'bloody good' is the kind of surprise that's worth a quick reaction from the hosts.*

- **'Carrie'** is getting a brand-new film adaptation of **Stephen King's** classic novel
- Early **Rotten Tomatoes** reviews are trending positive, bucking the usual skepticism around horror remakes
- It's the latest attempt to retell the story after the **1976** original and the **2013** version

The Debate Starter

- Can a horror remake ever actually top the original, or is this just another case of low expectations making it look better than it is?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.forbes.com/sites/timlammers/2026/10/05/carrie-rotten-tomatoes-reviews-new-adaptation-of-stephen-king-novel-is-bloody-good/

■ *Raider Nation bashes Taylor Swifts look by trolling Travis Kelce*

The Angle: *Swift and Kelce can't catch a break from rival fan bases, and this one's got a visual - a sign-waving Raiders fan going viral for dragging Swift's look mid-game. It's the NFL-meets-pop-culture crossover that always gets people talking.*

- Happened during the **Raiders vs. Chiefs** Sunday thriller at **Allegiant Stadium**
- A Raiders fan held up a sign featuring **Travis Kelce** and **Taylor Swift's** faces
- The sign was roasting **Swift's appearance**, not just her presence at the game
- Raider Nation has a history of trolling the Kelce-Swift romance during matchups

The Debate Starter

- Is trolling a celebrity's looks at a football game funny rivalry fuel or just mean - where's the line?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/05/sports/raiders-fan-calls-out-taylor-swifts-appeance-in-troll-against-travis-kelce/

■ *Jonquel Jones can’t let Angel Reese continue to torment Liberty*

The Angle: *Angel Reese is already a must-watch, lightning-rod star in the WNBA, and now she's got the defending favorites on the ropes in a semifinal series - that's exactly the kind of underdog-vs-villain storyline that pulls casual fans into the playoffs.*

- **Angel Reese** and the **Atlanta Dream** took **Round 1** of their semifinal series on **Sunday**
- The series is against the **New York Liberty**, with **Jonquel Jones** now facing pressure to shut Reese down
- Headline frames it as Reese being able to **"torment"** the Liberty if nothing changes

The Debate Starter

- Is Angel Reese just built differently in the playoffs, or is this a Liberty problem waiting to fix itself?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/05/sports/jonquel-jones-cant-let-angel-reese-continue-to-torment-liberty/

Backup options:

■ *‘Yellowstone’ spinoff ‘Marshals’ is back for Season 2—How to watch for free - Page Six*

The Angle: *Yellowstone fans can't get enough of this universe, and now there's a free way to watch the next chapter without paying for another streaming subscription — that's the kind of tip listeners actually want.*

- **'Marshals'** — the **Yellowstone** spinoff — returns for **Season 2**, about **four months** after it last aired.
- There's a **free way to watch**, according to the report — prime hack material for cord-cutters.

The Watercooler Tip

- Who else is still deep in the Yellowstone-verse — and does anyone actually know how to watch this one for free?

Page Six (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/10/04/entertainment/where-to-watch-marshals-season-2-premiere-live-for-free/

■ *‘Avengers: Endgame’ Returns to No. 1 on All-Time Global Box Office Chart, Surpassing ‘Avatar’ - The Hollywood Reporter*

The Angle: *Marvel's 2019 juggernaut got a surprise theatrical re-release and clawed its way back to the No. 1 spot on the all-time global box office chart — a fun flex just as hype builds for the next Avengers movie.*

- **Avengers: Endgame** (2019) reclaimed the **No. 1 spot** on the all-time global box office chart
- It overtook **Avatar**, which had held the top spot

- **Disney** re-released it as 'Endgame: Encore,' now in its **second weekend** back in theaters
- Timing is no accident — it's built to hype this year's upcoming **'Doomsday'**

The Debate Starter

- Is Endgame actually the better movie, or does Avatar just keep getting bumped by re-release gimmicks?

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/avengers-endgame-beats-avatar-highest-grossing-box-office-1236721833/

■ *Tom Cruise's 'Digger' Buried at Box Office With $8M as 'Verity' Wins Weekend - The Hollywood Reporter*

The Angle: *Tom Cruise is supposed to be the last true box office sure-thing, so when his new satire opens to a measly **$8M** and gets beaten by a horror movie, that's a real 'is movie stardom dead' watercooler moment.*

- **Tom Cruise** stars in **'Digger,'** a satirical black comedy for **Warner Bros.**
- The film is directed by Oscar winner **Alejandro G. Iñárritu**
- It opened to just **$8 million**, landing as a major financial loss for the studio
- Horror thriller **'Verity'** won the weekend box office instead

The Debate Starter

- Does Tom Cruise still move the needle, or does even a movie star need a crowd-pleasing movie to show up?

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/tom-cruise-digger-bombs-box-office-opening-verity-1236721814/

■ *James Gunn Confirms He's 'Already' Writing His Next Film Ahead of 'Superman: Man of Tomorrow' - Variety*

The Angle: *The guy hasn't even released 'Superman: Man of Tomorrow' yet and he's teasing what's next - classic DC universe hype that keeps fans guessing and talking.*

- **James Gunn** posted on **Threads** that he's already writing his next film.
- This comes well ahead of **'Superman: Man of Tomorrow,'** which doesn't hit theaters until **July 9, 2027**.
- Gunn dropped the reveal casually, replying to a fan comment online.

The Speculation Starter

- Callers - what do you want Gunn's next DC project to be, and are we even ready for more before Superman drops?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/james-gunn-next-project-superman-man-of-tomorrow-1236898696/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Hasan Piker has been named the #49 most most powerful person of 2026 by Vanity Fair, making him the only influencer to make the list.*

The Angle: *Vanity Fair dropped its most powerful people of 2026 list and left-wing streamer Hasan Piker landed at #49 — the only influencer to crack it at all. That's a real flashpoint for the 'is internet fame actual power' debate.*

- **Hasan Piker** ranked **#49** on **Vanity Fair's** 2026 most powerful people list.
- He's the **only influencer** to make the list this year.
- The ranking puts a streamer in the same conversation as traditional political and media power players.

The Debate Starter

- Is a streamer actually 'more powerful' than half the names on that list, or is this just Vanity Fair chasing relevance?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/gallery/1wykdsw

Backup options:

■ *Starbucks announces return of viral Bearista cup, new winter drinks*

The Angle: *This little bear-shaped cup broke the internet last year - people were reselling it online for way more than they paid - so the second Starbucks says "it's back," that's instant watercooler talk.*

- **Starbucks** is officially bringing back the **Bearista cup** - the winter cup that went viral and sold out almost instantly last time around
- The chain is also rolling out **new winter drinks** alongside the cup's return
- Expect the usual scramble: lines, limited stock, and resellers trying to flip it online

The Debate Starter

- Are you actually braving the Starbucks line for a cup, or is this whole thing just manufactured hype?

USA Today (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 77/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMirgFBVV95cUxORklvT293SmJMcXdidkV3NjQ5R3RkNHg2OFI2N2U4aXB6RkU5eWF6ZkNac1lGVHVxTndrS1d5SVZBa0VzNzZQS1Ntblo1RG5ZYWkyWS01ZzUxWXh3NXg1cmMxOWt4eVR5Rjd4SEkzd0w3X291OXpjQzZudEtNenZRTFQ5NGthbkh0b0dtbDYzRUxEVkgzRDJoaC1uQkgzUFZwVXRPVGdjdndZY1JoTWc?oc=5

■■ *Health Influencer Brags About Drinking From a Radioactive Jug for 250 Days Straight*

The Angle: *A wellness influencer is bragging about drinking from a radium-laced jug every day for over eight months straight — the exact stuff the U.S. banned a century ago because it was giving people cancer. It's the kind of 'wellness trend gone wrong' story that's tailor-made for two hosts to just say 'wait, WHY' out loud.*

- Radium water products were **banned in the U.S. roughly 100 years ago** after they were linked to cancer and other serious health harms.
- The influencer claims to have been drinking from the **radioactive jug for 250 days straight**.
- Radium exposure historically caused bone decay, tumors, and death in early 20th-century users and factory workers — this isn't a new or unknown risk.

The Debate Starter

- Where's the line between 'wellness trend' and 'actively poisoning yourself on camera for engagement'?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/health-influencer-brags-about-drinking-from-a-radioactive-jug-for-250-days-straight-2000821809

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Women suffer more pain than men across the whole body, major global study finds*

The Angle: *A major global study claims women report more pain than men in basically every part of the body — which lines up with what a lot of women have been saying for years about not being taken seriously by doctors.*

- The study looked at pain levels **across the whole body**, not just one condition or area.
- Finding: **women report higher pain levels than men**, broadly and consistently.
- It's described as a **major global study**, suggesting a large-scale dataset rather than one small sample.

The Debate Starter

- Ask callers: has a doctor ever brushed off your pain — and do you think gender played a role?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theguardian.com/society/2026/oct/05/women-more-pain-than-men-global-study

Backup options:

■■ *When the clocks stop changing. Research shows permanent standard time is the preferred choice for health, as it preserves morning light and aligns with human circadian biology. This can lead to improved sleep, mood, and overall health, particularly for vulnerable populations*

The Angle: *With clocks about to fall back again, new research says we're picking the wrong time to lock in — permanent standard time, not daylight time, is what actually matches our body clocks and our sleep.*

- Researchers say **permanent standard time** — not daylight time — is the healthier year-round choice.
- The reasoning: standard time preserves **morning light**, which lines up with human **circadian biology**.
- Benefits linked to standard time include better **sleep**, improved **mood**, and overall health gains.
- Health effects are flagged as especially significant for **vulnerable populations**.

The Debate Starter

- Call in: are you Team 'lock the clocks' or do you secretly love the extra hour of summer evening light?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Set the stakes** - 30 seconds, cold open -> Host reads the headline: scientists say permanent STANDARD time, not daylight time, is the healthy pick — ask co-host to guess which one most people actually want.
- **Step 2: Morning person vs. night person** - 1-2 min back-and-forth -> Each host argues their side — one defends dark mornings/light evenings (daylight time), the other defends light mornings (standard time) — played for friendly conflict.
- **Step 3: Phone lines / socials** - Open for 3-5 min -> Take calls or read comments on which one listeners would vote for if they got to pick permanently, no more changing the clocks.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.eurekalert.org/news-releases/1146225

■■ *Women with the same medical condition as men are less likely to be offered treatment such as surgery, a stent or a strong painkiller, research has found published in PLOS One.*

The Angle: *New research says women get the short end of the stick medically — even with the exact same condition as a man, they're less likely to get offered surgery, a stent, or strong pain meds. It's the kind of gender-gap story that makes everyone think of their own doctor's visits.*

- Study published in **PLOS One** looked at men and women with the **same medical condition**
- Women were **less likely** to be offered **surgery**
- Women were also less likely to be offered a **stent**
- Even pain relief wasn't equal — women less likely prescribed a **strong painkiller**

The Debate Starter

- Ladies — has a doctor ever brushed off your pain or symptoms in a way you think a man wouldn't have dealt with? Call in.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.theguardian.com/science/2026/sep/16/women-with-same-health-conditions-as-men-less-likely-to-be-offered-active-treatment

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CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *Switzerland becomes first country to ban fur imports and sales*

The Angle: *It's a world-first ban, so it's a clean, feel-good wrap-up story with a built-in debate: animal rights win vs. fashion freedom, perfect for a light end-of-show chat.*

- **Switzerland** is now the **first country in the world** to ban both the **import and sale** of fur.
- The move positions Switzerland ahead of the EU and other nations that have only restricted fur farming, not retail sales.
- It's being celebrated by animal rights groups as a landmark, precedent-setting policy.

The Debate Starter

- Would you back a fur ban here, or does telling people what they can't wear go too far?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.humaneworld.org/en/blog/switzerland-bans-fur-imports-and-sales

Backup options:

■ *Robots are cleaning desert solar panels every night without using a drop of water, helping keep them productive while saving about 2.6 billion gallons of water and cleaning more than 3.9 billion panels to date across 5,000+ MW of solar projects.*

The Angle: *It's a feel-good tech story with a wild stat attached - robots scrubbing solar panels clean every night in the desert, saving billions of gallons of water in the process. Great little 'wait, how does that even work' closer.*

- Robots clean solar panels overnight in desert installations - **no water used at all**
- They've saved roughly **2.6 billion gallons of water** so far
- More than **3.9 billion panels** cleaned to date
- Covers solar projects totaling over **5,000 MW**

The Wow Factor

- Dust-covered solar panels lose power output fast in the desert - so someone built robots to squeegee millions of them clean every night without wasting a drop of water.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/robots-built-by-the-israeli-company-ecoppia-roll-along-desert-solar-panels-every-night-and-brush-off-the-dust-without-a-drop-of-water-saving-about-2-6-billion-gallons-so-far-according-to-the-company/37450/

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/5 this month; TECH TALK 1/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *Judge calls warrantless Flock search unconstitutional mass surveillance, throws out drug evidence*

The Angle: *Flock's license-plate cameras are quietly scanning streets in thousands of towns across North America, and this ruling could blow up how police use them without a warrant — a privacy fight that touches basically every driver.*

- A judge ruled that police pulling data from **Flock** license-plate cameras without a warrant counts as unconstitutional **mass surveillance**.
- Because of that ruling, **drug evidence** collected through the warrantless search got **thrown out** of the case.
- **Flock** camera networks are already running in communities nationwide, so this decision could ripple well beyond the one case.

The Debate Starter

- Does catching criminals justify tracking every car on the road without a warrant — or is that just surveillance with a badge?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/114097-judge-calls-warrantless-flock-search-unconstitutional-mass-surveillance.html

■ *A California retiree started picking up litter alone on her daily walks in 2020. Six years later, she has rallied 250+ volunteers who have removed nearly 750,000 pounds of trash across the San Fernando Valley*

The Angle: *A solo cleanup walk in 2020 turned into a full-blown grassroots movement — it's the kind of one-person-snowballs-into-an-army story that makes you want to go do something with your own weekend.*

- Started in **2020** with one retiree picking up litter alone on daily walks
- Six years later, she's rallied **250+ volunteers**
- The group has hauled out nearly **750,000 pounds** of trash
- All of it across the **San Fernando Valley** in California

The Feel-Good Challenge

- What's one small habit you could start tomorrow that might snowball into something huge?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/pounds-of-trash-san-fernando-valley/37716/

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *Man Makes Prosthetic Legs from Easy-to-Find Bike Parts, and He’s Giving the Revolutionary Design Away for Free (Exclusive)*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Open-source, free-to-use prosthetic design from everyday bike parts hits the maker/DIY and assistive-tech communities hard and has a built-in 'exclusive' hook that outlets love to amplify.

The Angle: *A feel-good one for the goodbyes — an everyday inventor cracks a cheap, DIY fix for prosthetics and instead of cashing in, hands the design to anyone who needs it.*

- The design reportedly uses **easy-to-find bike parts** instead of expensive specialty components.
- He's **giving the design away for free** rather than patenting or selling it.
- Story is being called a **"revolutionary design"** by the outlet covering it.

The Feel-Good Finisher

- This is the kind of story that makes you want to look up his design and send it to someone — pure good-news fuel to end the show on.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/michigan-man-creates-prosthetic-legs-from-repurposed-bike-parts-12152651

■ *Zara Removes Halloween Costume Likened to Concentration Camp Uniform*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A major global retailer pulling a Halocaust-evoking Halloween costume right as Halloween shopping season kicks off is a brand-name outrage story primed for a fast news cycle.

The Angle: *A retail giant's Halloween costume reportedly got compared online to a concentration camp uniform — the kind of corporate fashion blunder that writes its own punchline and makes for an easy "how did that get approved" close-of-show chat.*

- **Zara** pulled a Halloween costume from sale after it was likened online to a **concentration camp uniform**.
- The story surfaced via **r/nottheonion** — the subreddit for real news that reads like satire.
- No word yet from **Zara** on how the design made it to shelves in the first place.

The Facepalm Moment

- How does something like that get through design, marketing, AND legal before it hits a store shelf?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thejewishnews.com/jewish-telegraphic-agency/zara-removes-halloween-costume-likened-to-concentration-camp-uniform/article_13cd0780-2054-4e89-b645-4f2ebeefa8ae.html

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■ *Alexander Wang Taps Dominatrix To Tape Nearly Naked Man to NYC Street Pole for Handbag Launch*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A famous designer using a dominatrix to tape a nearly naked man to a NYC pole for a handbag launch is pure shock-value stunt content tailor-made for r/nottheonion-style spread.
The Angle: *A literal half-naked man duct-taped to a NYC street pole as handbag marketing is exactly the kind of unhinged stunt that makes r/nottheonion trend - it's absurd, it's visual, and it practically begs for hosts to debate 'genius or insane?'*

- Fashion designer **Alexander Wang** is behind the stunt
- He reportedly hired a **dominatrix** for the bit
- A **nearly naked man** was taped to a street pole in **NYC**
- The whole thing was staged to launch a new **handbag**

The Debate Starter

- Marketing genius or has fashion completely lost the plot - what's the weirdest stunt you've seen a brand pull to sell a product?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fashiontimes.co.uk/alexander-wang-rocco-bag-soho-street-performance-1765052

■ *How a School Was Accidentally Sold at Auction*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): 'A school got accidentally sold at auction' is the kind of absurd, easily-digestible 'how is that even possible' headline that travels fast with minimal context needed.
The Angle: *A real 'you had ONE job' moment — somehow a school ended up on the auction block by mistake, and now someone's scrambling to undo it. Classic too-weird-not-to-share goodbye story.*

The Oops Factor

- What's the most ridiculous thing you've ever seen a government or office accidentally mess up on paperwork?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ilmattino.it/en/how_a_school_was_accidentally_sold_at_auction-9805059.html

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■ *US, China And Russia Race To Build Nuclear Reactors On The Moon: Report*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Framing US/China/Russia as racing to put nuclear reactors on the Moon plays directly into renewed space-race and great-power-competition narratives that have been trending all year.
The Angle: *This is basically a new space race, but with nuclear reactors instead of flags — whoever powers a moon base first could control how the Moon gets used going forward, and that's got people nervous.*

- **The US** is targeting a lunar nuclear reactor launch by **2030**.
- **Russia and China** are teaming up on a rival reactor project aimed at **2036**.
- The goal for both sides: steady power for future **Moon bases**.
- Experts are already raising **safety concerns** about putting nuclear reactors on the lunar surface.

The Debate Starter

- Is this smart long-term planning for living on the Moon, or a nuclear arms race with extra steps?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ndtv.com/world-news/us-china-and-russia-race-to-build-nuclear-reactors-on-the-moon-report-12137354

■ *Amber Alert issued for 7-year-old Alberta girl RCMP say was abducted from home*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): An active Amber Alert for an abducted 7-year-old is urgent, shareable-for-safety content that tends to spike fast regardless of starting engagement.
The Angle: *An active Amber Alert for a child abducted right out of her own home is exactly the kind of urgent, share-now story that gets phones buzzing across the province - and it's still unfolding live.*

- **RCMP** issued an **Amber Alert** for a missing **7-year-old girl** in **Alberta**
- Police say she was **abducted from her home**
- No suspect description or vehicle details confirmed yet in available reporting

The Safety Alert

- If you're anywhere near Alberta, check your phone and share this now - Amber Alerts only work as fast as people spread them.

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/edmonton/amber-alert-9.7369671

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Channing Tatum addresses claims he trolled ex Zoë Kravitz online using burner account: ‘Wtf come on’" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-22)
- "VMAs 2026 best and worst moments: Dolly Parton tributes, Madonna’s bizarre speeches" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-27)
- "Hundreds of lefties link arms for bizarre ‘hands across the sand’ protest against California oil drilling" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-28)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 13 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-20)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-22)
- "1Retro adds cloud saves to RetroArch, OpenEmu, and other gaming platforms" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-22)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-23)
- "‘The Visit’ at Pasadena Playhouse Review: The ’50s Absurdist Comedy Is Too Smug in Its Peak-Bleak View of Venal Humanity, but Jefferson Mays and Melinda Page Hamilton Are Worth the Visit" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-23)
- "Neil Patrick Harris to Star in ‘Damn Yankees’ Broadway Revival" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-27)
- "Neil Patrick Harris and Julianne Hough to Lead First Broadway Revival of Damn Yankees in Over 30 Years - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-27)
- "Neil Patrick Harris Will Lead Damn Yankees Broadway Revival Spring 2027 - Playbill" (Playbill.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-09-28)
- "Kawhi Leonard has fun with Ka’Wine & Dine revival at Raptors media day: ‘I can’t eat as much’" (Toronto Star (via Google News), banked 2026-09-29)
- "Less than two weeks shy of the one-year anniversary of ‘The Life of a Showgirl,’ Taylor Swift surprised fans by releasing four bonus tracks " (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-29)
- "SteelSeries brings ultra-wideband wireless to gaming mice, chasing lag-free tracking" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-30)
- "A top QB showdown and a historic anniversary: 5 things to know from the NFL this week - CNN" (CNN (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-10-02)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- 2 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-10-05 11:42 PM